

# This cat.



1/9

## THE FACTS

One sheet each – print it again for the second ...

Name \_\_\_\_\_

Called, actually \_\_\_\_\_

Born or about \_\_\_\_\_ Came home \_\_\_\_\_

Colour and markings \_\_\_\_\_

Breed, or best guess \_\_\_\_\_

Neutered \_\_\_\_\_ Indoor / out \_\_\_\_\_

## THE NUMBERS YOU CANNOT LOOK UP IN A HURRY

Microchip number \_\_\_\_\_

Chip registered with \_\_\_\_\_

Insurance, and policy number \_\_\_\_\_

Registered at (practice) \_\_\_\_\_

### A microchip is only as good as the phone number on it

The chip itself never changes and never expires, but the record attached to it does. If you have moved, changed your number, or the cat came from someone else, the details are very often still theirs. Log in once, check it, and write the date on page 3.

## WHERE THEY CAME FROM

Breeder, shelter or found \_\_\_\_\_

Anything known about before \_\_\_\_\_

## PHOTOGRAPHS, IN CASE THEY ARE LOST

☐ Clear head-on photograph, taken this year

☐ Both sides, and anything unusual

☐ Stored somewhere other than your phone

## WHAT THEY ARE LIKE

What a stranger would need

Friendly with \_\_\_\_\_

Not friendly with \_\_\_\_\_

Where they hide \_\_\_\_\_

What frightens them \_\_\_\_\_

How they ask for food \_\_\_\_\_

How they ask to be left alone \_\_\_\_\_

Picked up? How? \_\_\_\_\_

## THINGS THEY ALREADY DO THAT ARE THEIRS

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## OTHER ANIMALS IN THE HOUSE

WHO HOW THEY GET ON

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# Numbers, and when to use them.



## THE PRACTICE

Vet

Daytime number

Address

## OUT OF HOURS – USUALLY SOMEWHERE ELSE

Who covers nights

Number

Address, and how long it takes

## ALSO WORTH HAVING

Insurance claim line

Microchip company

Poisons helpline

Whoever has a spare key

### Photograph this page once it is filled in

The moment you need the out-of-hours number is the moment you cannot find the folder. Fill it in, take a picture of it on your phone, and put the paper copy on the fridge rather than in a drawer.

## GETTING THERE

Worked out once, not at midnight

Carrier lives

Who drives, if it is the middle of the night

How long it takes

## PHONE NOW, DO NOT WAIT UNTIL MORNING

- ☐ Straining in the tray and producing little or nothing – especially a male cat
- ☐ Breathing with an open mouth, or fast shallow breathing at rest
- ☐ Sudden weakness or dragging of the back legs, often crying, legs cold
- ☐ Not eating at all for 24 hours, or hiding and not moving
- ☐ Eaten or chewed any part of a lily, or drunk the vase water
- ☐ Swallowed thread, string, tinsel or an elastic band – never pull it
- ☐ Repeated vomiting, a bloated belly, or a fall from a height

This list is the short version of what emergency vets ask people to come in for. It is not a diagnosis and it is not complete. A cat that seems wrong to you is a good enough reason to phone – you know this animal and they do not.

## ANYTHING ELSE TO WATCH FOR

# The year of care.

**ROUTINE CARE** ————— Intervals vary – the vet decides

**WHAT, AND HOW OFTEN****LAST****DUE****DONE**

Vaccination booster  
Yearly

☐

Worming  
Every 3 months

☐

Flea and tick  
Monthly, check the label

☐

Full check-up  
Yearly, twice over ten

☐

Teeth looked at  
At the check-up

☐

Claws checked  
Older cats especially

☐

Weighed  
Monthly, page 4

☐

Microchip details checked  
Yearly, and after moving

☐

**ANYTHING ONGOING** ————— Medication, a condition, a diet

**WHAT****DOSE AND WHEN****REPEAT**

☐

☐

☐

☐

**APPOINTMENTS MADE** —————

**WHAT FOR****WHEN****BEEN**

☐

☐

☐

**KEEP OUT OF THE HOUSE** – The short list, and the reason

Lilies, any part

Pollen and vase water too. Kidney failure. Emergency.

Paracetamol / acetaminophen

Never, in any dose. Also ibuprofen and aspirin.

Dog flea treatment

Permethrin is toxic to cats. Check every label.

Antifreeze

Sweet, and lethal in tiny amounts. Wipe up spills.

Onion, garlic, chives

Cooked or raw, including in gravy and baby food.

String, thread, tinsel

Swallowed, it cuts. Never pull on a visible end.

Lilies are the one people are surprised by: every part of a true lily is dangerous to cats, brushing pollen off a coat and licking it is enough, and there is no safe amount. If a bouquet arrives, take them out before it comes in.

**WHERE THE RECORDS LIVE** —————

Vaccination card

Insurance documents

Prescription food or medicine from

**COST OF THE YEAR** —————

Insurance

Food

Vet

Everything else

**WORTH ASKING AT THE NEXT CHECK-UP** —————

☐ Is this weight right for this cat?

☐ Do the teeth need doing?

☐ Is the flea and worm routine still the right one?

☐ Anything to expect at this age?

# Weight, every month.

SAME SCALES, SAME DAY OF THE MONTH - Kilos or pounds  
MONTH WEIGHT WHAT ELSE YOU NOTICED

|           |  |  |
|-----------|--|--|
| January   |  |  |
| February  |  |  |
| March     |  |  |
| April     |  |  |
| May       |  |  |
| June      |  |  |
| July      |  |  |
| August    |  |  |
| September |  |  |
| October   |  |  |
| November  |  |  |
| December  |  |  |

Why this page exists

A cat will not tell you it feels unwell and will often behave normally until it is very unwell indeed. Weight is the exception: it is a number, it does not depend on how you are feeling that day, and a steady drop over a few months is one of the earliest things a vet can act on. Weigh monthly, write it down even when it is boring, and take the page with you to the check-up.

HOW TO WEIGH A CAT WHO WILL NOT BE WEIGHED

- ☐ Weigh yourself, then yourself holding the cat
- ☐ Or the carrier with them in, minus the carrier
- ☐ The same scales every time; the number matters less than the change
- ☐ Same time of day, before food

IDEAL WEIGHT, IF THE VET HAS GIVEN ONE

Ideal Told on

BODY SHAPE, FELT NOT LOOKED AT

TAKE TO THE NEXT APPOINTMENT

☐

☐

☐

# Food and water.

WHAT THEY EAT

| WHAT | HOW MUCH | WHEN |
|------|----------|------|
|      |          |      |
|      |          |      |
|      |          |      |
|      |          |      |
|      |          |      |

TREATS About a tenth of the day's food

NEVER, FOR THIS CAT Allergies, a diet, or just a firm no

☐

☐

☐

WHERE THE FOOD IS KEPT

CHANGING FOOD Over a week, mixed in

☐

☐

☐

Cats are bad at drinking, and it matters

They evolved to get most of their water from what they caught, which is why a dry-food cat can run mildly short for years and why urinary trouble is so common. More bowls, in more places, **away from the food** and away from the tray; wide bowls rather than deep narrow ones; changed daily. Wet food is water as well as dinner.

WATER, WHERE IT IS Not next to the food

| WHERE | BOWL OR FOUNTAIN | DAILY                 |
|-------|------------------|-----------------------|
|       |                  | <input type="radio"/> |
|       |                  | <input type="radio"/> |
|       |                  | <input type="radio"/> |
|       |                  | <input type="radio"/> |

BOWLS AND WHERE THEY GO

- ☐ Food and water apart, in different rooms if you can
- ☐ Neither of them beside the litter tray
- ☐ Wide and shallow, so the whiskers are not squashed
- ☐ Somewhere they can eat with their back to a wall
- ☐ One feeding station per cat, spread out

IF THEY STOP EATING Phone if it reaches a day



Two cats means three trays, and they go in different places rather than in a row. Most cats prefer them uncovered, in a quiet spot with a way out, with fine unscented clumping litter deep enough to dig – and scooped every day. Almost every “he is doing it on the carpet” problem is a tray problem, a stress problem, or a medical one, in that order of how often.

| # | WHERE IT IS | LITTER USED   | OPEN                  |
|---|-------------|---------------|-----------------------|
| 1 | _____       | _____         | <input type="radio"/> |
| 2 | _____       | _____         | <input type="radio"/> |
| 3 | _____       | _____         | <input type="radio"/> |
| 4 | _____       | _____         | <input type="radio"/> |
|   | Scooped     | Emptied fully |                       |

○ Add the new tray before taking the old one away

- Mix new litter into old over a week or two
- Move a tray a little at a time, not across the house
- No scented litter, no strong cleaners – they can smell what you cannot

Litter brand

Bought from

How long a bag lasts

[illegible]

A cat going to the tray again and again and again and producing little or nothing – squatting, straining, crying, licking – may have a blocked bladder. In male cats this is a genuine emergency and hours matter. Do not wait to see if it settles overnight: phone the number on page 2.

# The indoor day.

**Play works when it looks like hunting**  
Stalk, chase, pounce, catch – and then feed. A wand toy moving **away** from the cat, like something escaping, beats a toy waved in their face. Two or three short sessions a day beat one long one, and every session should end with a catch they are allowed to keep, or it is just frustration. Lasers alone never let them catch anything; if you use one, land it on a real toy at the end.

| WHAT THIS CAT ACTUALLY LIKES |             | — Most have one type |
|------------------------------|-------------|----------------------|
| TOY OR GAME                  | HOW LONG    | KEEPS                |
| <div></div>                  | <div></div> | <div></div>          |
| <div></div>                  | <div></div> | <div></div>          |
| <div></div>                  | <div></div> | <div></div>          |
| <div></div>                  | <div></div> | <div></div>          |
| <div></div>                  | <div></div> | <div></div>          |

**ROTATE, DO NOT ADD** — Half away for a fortnight

**FOOD THAT TAKES WORK** - Enrichment and pacing at once

**SCRATCHING** — Both kinds, or the sofa becomes one

Something upright and tall enough to stretch full length

Something flat on the floor as well

One next to where they sleep – they scratch on waking

One where they already scratch, not where you would prefer

Sturdy enough not to wobble, or it will not be used

**WHERE THEY GET UP HIGH** Height is how a cat feels sa...

**THE WINDOW** — Somewhere to sit, something to watch

**SOMEWHERE NOBODY FOLLOWS THEM**

**WITH ANOTHER CAT IN THE HOUSE**

Beds, bowls and posts in more than one room

Somewhere each of them can be alone

Never fed nose to nose

# While we are away.

THE BASICS

Cat \_\_\_\_\_ Dates \_\_\_\_\_

Us, and the best number \_\_\_\_\_

If you cannot reach us \_\_\_\_\_

Vet, and out-of-hours (page 2) \_\_\_\_\_

Insurance policy number \_\_\_\_\_

| FEEDING |          |       | Amounts, not “a bit” |
|---------|----------|-------|----------------------|
| WHAT    | HOW MUCH | WHEN  |                      |
| _____   | _____    | _____ |                      |
| _____   | _____    | _____ |                      |
| _____   | _____    | _____ |                      |
| _____   | _____    | _____ |                      |

MEDICATION, IF ANY

| WHAT  | DOSE AND WHEN | GIVEN                 |
|-------|---------------|-----------------------|
| _____ | _____         | <input type="radio"/> |
| _____ | _____         | <input type="radio"/> |
| _____ | _____         | <input type="radio"/> |

WHERE EVERYTHING IS

| WHAT             | WHERE |
|------------------|-------|
| Food and bowls   | _____ |
| Litter and scoop | _____ |
| Spare litter     | _____ |
| Carrier          | _____ |
| Cleaning things  | _____ |
| Toys             | _____ |
| Spare key        | _____ |

**What to tell someone who has never met this cat**

Where they hide, and that hiding is normal for the first day. That they should be **seen** every visit, even if it means looking under a bed – a cat that has not been laid eyes on is the thing you need to know about. And that the tray tells you whether they are eating and drinking, so it gets checked even when it looks clean.

PLEASE DO, AND PLEASE DO NOT

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

MESSAGE US IF

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_





DATE \_\_\_\_\_

## WHAT YOU NOTICED

TOLD  
VET

Drinking more or less than usual. Sleeping somewhere new. Not jumping up where they always jump up. Eating more slowly. Grooming one patch bald. None of these is an emergency on the day, and all of them are the sort of thing a vet asks “how long has that been going on?” about – and this page is how you answer.

## QUESTIONS FOR THE NEXT APPOINTMENT

## WHAT THE VET SAID

## WHAT WE CHANGED, AND WHETHER IT HELPED